

Aldwych Bank · CFO Challenge

Getting to know the customer & the personas

This sheet gets you familiar with the **Aldwych Bank financial-services scenario** and the **people you'll meet** before the carousel, so you can walk in confident in the customer context. The decisions — including who to go and speak to first — are yours to make.

 **About what's not in this sheet.** This is your **pre-brief**. It gives you the customer context and the personas so you can walk in prepared. It does **not** hand you the answers — the hidden intelligence, the budgets, the prototype, the relationships between the people — that is **yours to discover through the conversations**. The gaps in this sheet are deliberate. Lean into them.

THE CHALLENGE · ALDWYCH BANK · FINANCIAL SERVICES

This is a discovery challenge, not a demo competition. You'll move around meeting stakeholders, and the goal is to gather enough insight to eventually present back to Aldwych Bank's CFO. Along the way you're effectively building a picture of a data-platform recommendation for Aldwych Bank.

Your mission — and the reason you have this access: you have a meeting with Aldwych Bank's CFO, Andrew Harper, scheduled for the following day. That pending CFO meeting is exactly why you've been granted unprecedented access to these key stakeholders today — to prepare you to sit in front of the CFO with real insight. Everything you do today is in service of that meeting.

Who's in the room: six stakeholders plus the CFO. There is no prescribed order to meeting them — who you speak to, and in what sequence, is entirely your team's call.

The CFO meeting itself runs differently to the six stakeholder meetings — it's more one-way, in your favour. You do most of the talking: it's your pitch and demo, not another round of discovery. The CFO will react and choose to probe a couple of objections rather than running a full back-and-forth. It's scored on three simplified criteria: **Going High, Going Wide, Going Fast** (0–3 each).

THE SEVEN PEOPLE YOU HAVE ACCESS TO TODAY

A James O'Brien

GSi Partner · Accenture

B Sarah Mitchell

Chief Risk Officer

C Marcus Okafor

Chief Technology Officer

D Charlotte Davies

Head of Group Data Architecture

E David Chen

Head of Model Risk Engineering

F Dr. Priya Mehta

Chief Data and AI Officer

 **Andrew Harper**

Chief Financial Officer — meeting tomorrow

HOW TO USE THIS SHEET

Three things this pre-brief does for you:

- **Paints the picture** — who Aldwych Bank is and the business problem at the centre of the challenge.
- **Introduces the cast** — the personas you'll meet, their roles, and what each genuinely cares about (at the level a good EA/SE would know before a first conversation).
- **Gives you a way to think** — guidance on approaching the room that leaves you, not the sheet, in control of who you see and when.

Read it, get curious, and then walk the floor with questions rather than assumptions.

THE CUSTOMER SITUATION

COMPANY

Aldwych Bank

REVENUE

~£40B

FY2023

DIVISIONS

4

Aldwych Bank · Aldwych
Commercial · Aldwych
Private · Aldwych Business

EMPLOYEES

~62k

SECTOR

Financial services

UK · regulated

GSi PARTNER

Accenture

12-year UK banking
relationship

Aldwych Bank is a UK financial-services group. Post ring-fencing regulation in 2019 it was required to hold its retail and market/investment activities as two legally separate estates — and that split is the root of the problem. Across its divisions the bank runs seven separate risk-data systems, with no unified customer risk view and no common data lineage.

The business is under heavy regulatory pressure. A BCBS 239 audit found a significant share of risk-data elements untraceable to their source, and the FCA issued a formal notice. The group P&L and regulatory submissions are assembled slowly — its monthly regulatory reporting cycle consumes roughly three weeks of manual work. Today the bank cannot trace a capital or regulatory figure back to the specific source-record calculations that produced it — a requirement at the heart of modern UK banking regulation.

A useful frame before you start: **everyone you meet is living with the cost of fragmented, unlineageable data**, but each sees it through their own lens — risk, technology, architecture, data, finance.

THE PEOPLE YOU'LL MEET

Six stakeholders plus the CFO. Here's who they are and what each genuinely cares about. Use the "why they matter" framing to think about how they each connect to the bigger picture.

A · PARTNER

James O'Brien

Managing Director, UK Banking Practice · Accenture

WHO

Accenture's lead on the Aldwych Bank relationship. Deep links into the bank's legacy estate, regulatory commitments and failed migrations.

WHY THEY MATTER

Partners sit outside the bank but see the whole account and market. James can give you context on the account and the competitive picture — what you do with his time is up to you.

WHAT JAMES CARES ABOUT

- The Aldwych relationship and how it's moving forward.
- Whether the platform decision is being made — and on what evidence.
- Comparable programmes he's run at other UK ring-fenced banks.
- Asking you what you came to find and how he can orient you.

B · BUSINESS OWNER

Sarah Mitchell

Chief Risk Officer

WHO

Owns the bank's regulatory and risk agenda. Career risk professional, previously CRO at another major bank.

WHY THEY MATTER

The FCA notice and BCBS 239 failure land on Sarah's desk. She has an approved remediation budget she can't spend, and she piloted a self-service analytics tool she's convinced about but had to pause.

WHAT SARAH CARES ABOUT

- The FCA formal notice and BCBS 239 compliance by the Q4 deadline.
- Getting her approved remediation budget moving.
- Making regulatory submissions self-service instead of a 3-week manual cycle.
- Whether the proposed data-platform "fix" actually resolves the compliance requirement.

C · TECHNOLOGY

Marcus Okafor

Chief Technology Officer

WHO

CTO. Joined Aldwych Bank from a major competitor bank 18 months ago, bringing first-hand experience of cloud and data-platform vendor evaluations.

WHY THEY MATTER

As CTO he holds the approval that unlocks everything — the architecture recommendation is Charlotte's (EA), but nothing proceeds without his endorsement. He's managing a significant Azure estate, competing platform conversations and internal politics — understanding his position matters for the recommendation.

WHAT MARCUS CARES ABOUT

- Security, resilience and compliance across the bank's estate.
- Managing the Microsoft/Azure enterprise relationship without a political fight.
- Internal alignment — approving on documented, defensible grounds.
- The sequencing that lets the architecture lead publish her conclusion.

D · TECHNOLOGY

Charlotte Davies

Head of Group Data Architecture

WHO

Governs Aldwych Bank's data architecture and standards. Built the investment-banking lineage model that passed the audit; stopped a failed migration on regulatory grounds.

WHY THEY MATTER

She owns the reference architecture and the technical case. She'll likely test your grasp of the lineage requirement — the central technical issue in this scenario.

WHAT CHARLOTTE CARES ABOUT

- Calculation-level lineage that satisfies BCBS 239 Principle 3, not just table-level lineage.
- Multi-system, multi-estate architecture done properly.
- Publishing a defensible reference architecture before an external deadline.
- Seeing whether you can hold your own on the technical detail.

E · DATA & ENGINEERING

David Chen

Head of Model Risk Engineering

WHO

Runs the engineering pipelines that pull the bank's risk data together. His team maintains the risk-data pipelines.

WHY THEY MATTER

Engineers are where the data actually lives. David (and implicitly his team) can tell you what's really built, what works, and what's been tried — the on-the-ground reality of the data estate.

WHAT DAVID CARES ABOUT

- Building and shipping real pipelines, not just talking strategy.
- Reducing the maintenance burden of fragmented legacy pipelines.
- Tooling and how his team works day to day.
- Recognition of the actual engineering work in his team.

F · DATA & AI

Dr. Priya Mehta

Chief Data and AI Officer

WHO

Leads Aldwych Bank's data and AI agenda. Responsible for both the data foundation and the AI outcomes it enables. Under CEO deadline and regulatory constraint.

WHY THEY MATTER

Priya connects the data foundation to AI outcomes — model reinstatement and the broader AI vision she holds for the bank. She holds the CEO's two-quarter deadline and the bridge between data governance and real AI business value.

WHAT PRIYA CARES ABOUT

- Getting AI models reinstated and AI results into the P&L — has a two-quarter CEO deadline.
- Meeting the regulator's training-data-provenance requirement (PRA SS1/23 = same architectural gap as BCBS Principle 3).
- What AI self-service at scale would look like for the bank's business leaders — beyond just reinstating models.
- Showing her leadership a real outcome within a tight timeline.

CFO

Andrew Harper

Chief Financial Officer

WHO

The CFO. Speaks the language of capital, regulatory risk and results. Finite attention — every decision ultimately lands with him.

WHY THEY MATTER

The final conversation is with Andrew. Everything you learn and recommend needs to land in his language: what it means for capital and P&L, what it costs, what it saves, what the first funded step is.

WHAT ANDREW CARES ABOUT

- The regulatory exposure and what failing the deadlines would cost.
- Why the bank's reporting is slow and what it's costing.
- Concrete value, not platform features.
- Whether he can trust that the recommendation is grounded in real contact with his people.

HOW TO APPROACH THE ROOM

THIS IS YOUR JUDGEMENT CALL

There is no prescribed order and no single "right" first stop. Deciding who to see, and in what sequence, is exactly what the challenge is testing — so it's deliberately left to your team's skill and intuition. Use the people profile above to weigh who's likely to give you the most useful starting point.

QUESTIONS TO WEIGH UP AS A TEAM

- Which person, tackled first, would give you the clearest read on the account and the decision in front of Aldwych Bank?
- Where problems connect most naturally to the others in the room — who's worth understanding early?
- Where do you need to end up, and what will you need to have gathered by then?
- As new signals emerge, are you willing to change your plan?

YOU'RE EMPOWERED TO SPLIT UP

You don't all have to see the same persona. Your team brings a mix of experience and backgrounds — lean into that. Split into smaller groups and cover more of the room in parallel, each bringing a different lens to the conversations. Teams work best when they use their people's strengths, divide and conquer sensibly, and then come back together to stitch what they each learned into a shared picture.

However you sequence it — and whether you go together or split up — own the decision as a team. You're being trusted to read the room and adapt.

LOGISTICS & CONSTRAINTS

A few practical rules shape how the day works. Factor them into your plan from the start.

TIME LIMITS & THE SPLIT

- You may see **up to 3 personas before lunch and up to 3 after lunch**. Even splitting up, you cannot realistically cover all six personas in the first few hours — plan your coverage across the day.
- Splitting up lets you cover more ground, but every group still counts towards your before/after lunch limits. Decide deliberately which personas you cover in parallel and which you hold for later.
- You are **not required to meet every persona**. If you don't have time, or you judge that a persona isn't likely to move your mission forward, it's a legitimate choice to skip them. Prioritise the meetings you believe will give you the most value.

BOOKING, FORMAT & THE BALANCE OF EACH MEETING

- Meetings with personas are booked through a **Google appointment schedule**, which will be shared with the teams when the simulation starts.
- Each meeting is **15 minutes**, followed by a **5-minute debrief** as a team.
- Use the 5-minute debrief to receive out-of-role feedback from the persona — what landed well, what missed, and where the score is likely to land. Team discussion of sequencing and next steps happens between sessions, not during the debrief.
- Every meeting should be a **mixture** of presentation and/or demo — to inform and influence the persona — **and** discovery — to learn more about the customer scenario and the person in front of you. You're influencing *and* listening in equal measure, not just pitching or just interviewing.

AFTER THE CAROUSEL — SE AFE CONSULTATION

AFTER YOUR PERSONA CAROUSEL — SE AFE CONSULTATION

Once your team has completed its persona sessions, the **SE AFE team will circulate room to room**. They offer approximately **15–20 minute consultations** — use this time to pressure-test your approach before the build.

BRING THESE QUESTIONS

- How should we frame the CFO narrative and funded first step?
- Which capability or demo should we lead with?
- How do we handle the competitive positioning cleanly?
- Which Snowflake features are most relevant to what we found today?

AFE WON'T DO

- Write the pitch, deck, or content for you.
- Reveal persona details, scoring criteria, or hidden scenario information.
- Do hands-on build or demo work alongside the team.

Before they arrive: agree as a team what you most need input on. Come with a clear question, not an open brief.

HOW TO PREPARE

Hold these in mind as you walk the floor — they'll shape the conversations you have and the picture you eventually present.

THINGS TO DO

- Know the shape of the customer: a UK bank split into ring-fenced estates, seven risk-data systems, a slow regulatory cycle, and active regulatory deadlines.
- Speak to these people as individuals — know their role and their stakes, not just their title.
- Ask "how is this working today?" and "what does this cost you?" — pain framed in business terms.
- Get specific on regulation: BCBS 239, Basel IV, and the model-governance requirements — these are the drivers.
- Listen for what connects one persona's problem to another's.

THINGS TO AVOID

- Leading with a platform pitch before understanding their world.
- Treating every persona as the same conversation.
- Assuming you already know the answer — the room holds information you won't have on paper.
- Racing to the CFO without the evidence the other conversations provide.
- Dismissing the incumbent platform or vendor angle without understanding why it's in place.

Walk in with questions and a plan for how you'll **decide together** who to see, in what order, and whether to cover the room together or split into smaller groups. The best teams treat the first 30 minutes as reconnaissance, not a pitch.

HOW EACH MEETING IS SCORED

These five criteria apply to the **six persona stations** — the same consistent rubric at every stop, so you know what good looks like. Each criterion is assessed **0–3** — the stronger the evidence in the meeting, the higher the score. **The CFO meeting the next day uses a different, simpler rubric** — see the callout below.

1

Lead with establishing credibility & context

Did they open by establishing credibility and context — grounding the conversation in the customer's reality and showing they understand the situation — before advancing their own view? Strong opening credibility earns the right to influence and sets up an informed, tailored conversation.

2

Discovery — uncover genuinely new information

Did they uncover information they **didn't have coming in** — insight that moves the team's understanding forward and shapes future meetings? Strong discovery is productive: it surfaces new intelligence that helps them get more out of the rest of the day and the CFO meeting tomorrow.

3

Customise to the persona

Did they adapt their approach, language and emphasis to *this* person — a CFO, an architect, an engineer — rather than delivering a generic, one-size-fits-all message? Evidence that they understood who they were talking to.

4

Capability mapped to the persona's challenge

Did they demonstrate capability — through presentation **and/or demo** — that directly maps to the specific challenge that persona is facing? This is deliberately persona-different: what resonates with the CTO differs from what resonates with the risk leader or the CFO. The better the fit between what they showed and what the persona actually needs, the higher the score.

5

Objection handling

When the persona pushed back, questioned, or raised a concern, did they handle it well — acknowledging it, responding credibly, and turning it into useful ground rather than dismissing or deflecting it? Good objection handling demonstrates depth, composure and genuine understanding of the customer's position.

Strongest meetings earn 3 in every criterion: you **establish credibility and context first**, you **uncover new information**, you **tailor to the person**, you **show something that speaks directly to their challenge**, and you **handle their objections with confidence** — all while building toward tomorrow's CFO conversation.

Why these meetings matter. Your **top 3 scores** from these persona meetings feed directly into your overall score in the CFO meeting. More importantly, these stakeholders carry influence — their views and perceptions of you reach the CFO **before** you even sit down tomorrow. Impress them and their endorsement precedes you; dismiss them and you arrive carrying that weight. Treat every meeting as a vote that lands before the CFO does.

THE CFO MEETING USES DIFFERENT CRITERIA

The CFO meeting is not scored against the five criteria above. It uses three simpler criteria, each still **0–3** — built for a one-way, presentation-style meeting where your team does most of the talking.

Going High

Sold to the C-suite in financial terms, backed by real discovery from today — named stakeholders, specific intelligence, a funded first step.

Going Wide

Platform breadth, not a point solution — capability connected across the estate into one story, not a single feature pitch.

Going Fast

AI-driven speed to value and genuine partnering — a live demo, not just a description, and objection handling grounded in evidence.